

Getting the revenue back

What the current subscriber base is worth if nothing changes, why it decays, and what each recovery lever is expected to return.

\$1,071

LIFETIME PROCEEDS

Total earned since launch.
\$1,043 of it in 15 days.

86

ACTIVE PLANS TODAY

Of which only 53 will ever bill
again.

\$56

COMMITTED PER DAY

From paying subscribers set to
renew.

~\$3

PER DAY AT DAY 90

Same base, no intervention.

THE HEADLINE

The current base is worth about \$1,000 over 90 days

Pick1 has earned **\$1,071 in its entire life**, and \$1,043 of that arrived in a single 15-day window in July as the World Cup signup surge cleared the 3-day trial. Revenue peaked at \$147 on 21 July — two days *after* the final — and has fallen since as that one cohort ages out.

Projected forward, everyone currently subscribed will generate roughly **\$1,014 over the next 90 days**. In other words, the entire active base is worth about as much from here on as the app has earned in its whole history. That is not an acquisition problem — new subscriptions are still arriving at about 11 a day. It is a retention problem.

The one number that is already excellent. Apple's peer benchmarks put Pick1's revenue per paying user at **\$28.00**, above the 75th percentile for subscription Sports apps (\$19.05). Pricing is the strongest thing in the business and should not be cut. The problem is that too few people ever start paying, and those who do leave after one cycle.

WHAT WE STILL HAVE

The active base, subscriber by subscriber

86 subscriptions are entitled today. Only 53 of them have auto-renew switched on — the other 33 have already cancelled and are simply running out the clock. That distinction is the whole projection.

Group	Subs	Net per cycle	Net per day	What happens next
Weekly, paying, renewing	28	\$333.32	\$47.62	Charged every 7 days. 27% survive to the next charge.
Monthly, paying, renewing	8	\$260.92	\$8.58	Charged every 30 days. Best retention in the base.
Weekly, in trial, renewing	17	\$234.08	—	Converts at 12.2%, so about 2 will become payers.
Cancelled, still entitled	33	\$0	\$0	Will lapse. No further revenue unless recovered.

Committed revenue from paying, renewing subscribers is **\$56.20 per day**. The 17 trials add roughly \$4 a day once conversion is applied. Currencies converted at approximate rates and shown net of Apple's 15% commission.

THE PROJECTION

Same base, no intervention

Applying the observed retention rates — 27% of weekly subscribers survive to their next charge, and 12.2% of trials convert — the current base decays as follows.

Period	Weekly	Monthly	Trials	Total	Average per day
Days 1–30	\$454	\$261	\$39	\$754	\$25
Days 31–60	\$8	\$157	—	\$165	\$6
Days 61–90	—	\$94	—	\$95	\$3
90-day total	\$462	\$512	\$39	\$1,014	\$11

Revenue starts at about \$56 a day and ends near \$3. Note that monthly subscribers — only 8 of them — contribute more over 90 days than all 28 weekly subscribers combined. That is the single most important fact on this page.

WHY IT DECAYS

Three leaks, all measurable

Leak	Pick1	Benchmark	What it costs
Trial converts to paid	12.2%	30–40% typical	484 of 551 subscriptions died at exactly 3.0 days — at the trial wall, never reaching a first payment.
Weekly subscriber survives to 2nd charge	27%	50–60% typical	67 first payments became 18 second payments and 2 third payments.
Subscriptions lost to a failed card	17.6%	5–8%	102 of 573 never chose to leave. The payment was declined and nothing told them.
Download becomes a payer	1.48%	2.68% peer median	Closing to the median is a 1.8x revenue multiple on identical traffic.
User returns on day 1	20.7%	26.0% peer median	A user who never comes back a second time never converts.

The weekly plan compounds all of this. At \$14.99 a week it forces four cancel decisions a month, and roughly three-quarters of subscribers are lost at each one. Monthly is already the default on the paywall and is **38% cheaper per week** (\$9.23 against \$14.99) — yet 79% of subscribers still choose weekly, because \$14.99 is a smaller number than \$39.99.

ALREADY FIXED

Shipped on 28 July

Change	Status	What it addresses
Apple Billing Grace Period (16 days)	Live	Was never enabled. Card failures turned straight into cancellations — 17.6% of the base. Apple now keeps retrying for 16 days while the subscriber keeps access.
Failed-payment notification	Live	Tells a subscriber their card was declined and links to the screen that fixes it. Nothing did this before.
Cancellation save notification	Live	Reaches subscribers who switched off auto-renew, 16–48 hours before they lapse. First contact this segment has ever had.
Day-one return notification	Live	Attacks the 20.7% day-1 retention rate directly.
Trial-ending notification	Live	Two versions, depending on whether the subscriber has already cancelled.
Email fallback, 7 languages	Built, dormant	Reaches the 30% of lapsed subscribers who cannot be reached by notification. Waiting on one missing API key.

WHERE THE RECOVERY COMES FROM

Two audiences, sized

Beyond the 86 active subscriptions there are two much larger populations, and they need completely different treatment.

Audience	People	Reachable now	The play	Expected recovery
Trialled, never paid	338	158	A discounted full month — long enough to see the pattern 3 days never showed.	3–8%
Lost to a failed card	96	65	Already addressed by grace period plus the failed-payment notification.	40–60%
Paid, then left	16	9	Small enough to approach individually. Proven willingness to pay.	15–25%
Have the app, never paid	2,012	227 weekly active	Paywall rebuild and a first-purchase offer. The compounding opportunity.	1.8x conversion

Note on mechanism: Apple's Win-Back Offers cannot be used here. Apple requires a customer to have previously paid for at least one month to qualify, and Pick1's typical paid lifetime is a single week — so virtually none of the 452 lapsed users are eligible. Redeemable offer codes carry no such restriction and also work on the never-paid audience.

SCENARIOS

What the next 90 days look like

	Do nothing	Execute the plan
Revenue from today's active base	\$1,014	\$1,250–1,500
One-off reactivation revenue	\$0	\$400–900
Steady-state run rate at day 90	\$20–25 / day	\$50–80 / day
Trial converts to paid	12.2%	18–22%
Weekly survives to 2nd charge	27%	38–45%
Lost to failed cards	17.6%	under 8%
90-day revenue	~\$1,700	~\$3,400–4,800

"Do nothing" still includes the roughly 11 new subscriptions arriving each day at current conversion rates — it is not a zero baseline. The difference between the columns is entirely retention and conversion, with no additional advertising spend in either.

ORDER OF WORK

Sequenced so nothing waits on a slow experiment

When	What	Why this order
Days 1–7	Unblock email. Publish a discounted-month offer code and send it to all 452 lapsed users through the notification system already running. Approach the 16 former payers directly.	None of this depends on new traffic. It is the only revenue available immediately.
Days 8–21	Rebuild the paywall: lead with the public results ledger, and present weekly against monthly so the real value comparison is visible. Ship result notifications to free users.	Affects every future subscriber. A monthly subscriber is worth three to four times a weekly one.
Weeks 4–9	Test a 7-day trial against the current 3-day trial.	At about 10 trial starts a day this needs 4–6 weeks to read honestly, so it must start early. Reports as the NFL season opens.

WHAT WE NEED

Three decisions and one key

Item	Owner	Detail
Resend API key	Client	One missing environment variable. It unblocks email to the 220 lapsed users notifications cannot reach — and also switches on the welcome email and new-subscriber alerts, neither of which has ever worked.
Discount level on the comeback offer	Client	An offer code campaign already exists in App Store Connect at 50% off the first month, created but never sent to anyone. Confirm 50% or set a different figure.
Code type	Client	One reusable code is far simpler to distribute by notification and email. Unique single-use codes are more controlled but need per-user assignment.
Paywall design work	Both	Approval to change the paywall layout and plan presentation. This requires an App Store review cycle.

What this plan does not do. Everything here raises revenue per user. None of it raises the number of users. At the current rate of roughly 67 signups a day, executing all of it lands the business somewhere around \$50–80 a day — a real recovery from a base otherwise decaying toward nothing, but a ceiling rather than a growth curve.

Growth needs advertising restarted. The case for that gets stronger after this work, not weaker: organic signup-to-subscription now runs near 27% against 9.9% during the World Cup surge, so a future advertising dollar buys roughly three times what it bought in July. Fix the funnel first, then fill it.